TERTIARY INFOTECH ACADEMY

Generative AI for Finance and Fintech

Learner Guide

Concepts, detailed procedures, lab evidence and responsible finance-AI practice

Course code	TGS-2026065050
TSC	ACC-ICT-5004-1.1 · Digital Technology Adoption and Innovation
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Duration	4 days · 30 classroom hours + 2 assessment hours

Controlled learning document

Document Version Control Record

Document	Version	Date	Change summary
Learner Guide	4.0	23 August 2026	Complete redesign aligned to TGS-2026065050, current Microsoft copilots, finance AI use cases, labs, security and assessment evidence.

Table of Contents

Open in Word and update this field if page numbers change.

How to use this guide

Slides versus guide
The trainer deck is concept-led. Detailed click-by-click and evidence procedures are intentionally contained here and in the individual lab folders.

Learning outcomes

- LO1: Support Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Generative AI innovations to champion organisation-wide innovation.
- LO2: Evaluate and implement GAI technologies for the organisation.
- LO3: Review and adopt new GAI technologies by reviewing use cases in finance operations.
- LO4: Review AI ethics and governance in organisation processes for proactive risk monitoring and safety.
- LO5: Review emerging trends in GAI and strategise cost-control measures to support innovation initiatives.

Course map

Topic	Focus	Criteria
1	Introduction to Generative AI and Its Foundations in Finance	K2 · A1
2	Excel Copilot for Finance Planning and Analysis	K1 · A2
3	Practical Applications of Agentic AI to Automate Financial Processes	A3
4	AI Risk Management, Security and Fraud Detection	K3 · A4
5	Future Trends and Innovations in Generative AI for Finance	K4 · A5

Assessment

- Written Assessment (SAQ): 4 open-ended questions, 60 minutes, open book, K2/K1/K3/K4.
- Case Study (CS): 5 integrated tasks, 60 minutes, open book, A1-A5.
- No practice examination is included. The assessment mirrors the live legacy instrument count, mapping and timing.

Topic 1: Introduction to Generative AI and Its Foundations in Finance

AI, machine learning, GenAI, agents, finance value chains and responsible innovation
Competency focus: K2 · A1

Core concepts

AI, ML, GenAI and agents

These are nested capabilities, not interchangeable labels.

- AI performs tasks associated with intelligence
- Machine learning learns patterns from data
- Generative AI creates or transforms content
- Agents pursue goals by selecting knowledge and tools

The finance decision loop

Finance AI creates value only when insight changes an accountable decision.

- Observe transactions and business drivers
- Interpret signals in financial context
- Recommend or execute a bounded action
- Record evidence, approvals and outcomes

Generative versus predictive AI

Prediction estimates what may happen; generation explains, drafts or synthesises.

- Credit default probability is predictive
- A variance narrative is generative
- Fraud triage often combines both
- Controls differ by impact and autonomy

Agentic AI anatomy

A useful agent is a governed system of instructions, knowledge, tools and memory.

- Instructions define purpose and boundaries
- Knowledge grounds answers
- Tools perform permitted actions
- Identity and memory preserve context safely

Single-agent versus multi-agent

Specialisation can improve clarity, but orchestration adds failure modes.

- Single agents are simpler to test
- Multi-agent systems separate roles
- Handoffs need contracts and logs
- A supervisor agent must not become an unbounded approver

Where finance creates value

The strongest early uses reduce repetitive analysis while preserving judgement.

- Close and reconciliation
- Planning and variance analysis
- Collections and working capital
- Risk, compliance and audit support

Three horizons of adoption

Assist, automate and transform require progressively stronger controls.

- Assist: draft and analyse
- Automate: execute repeatable bounded steps
- Transform: redesign end-to-end work
- Autonomy rises only with evidence

Data grounding

Finance answers must be tied to authoritative, dated and permissioned sources.

- Use controlled workbooks and ERP extracts
- Retain source links and as-of dates
- Separate facts from assumptions
- Do not infer missing accounting policy

Prompt contracts for finance

A strong prompt names the role, task, data boundary, controls and output schema.

- State the finance objective
- Define allowed sources
- Require reconciliations and caveats
- Specify tables, units and review status

Human accountability

AI can prepare and recommend; accountable people approve material finance decisions.

- Define preparer and reviewer roles
- Set monetary and risk thresholds
- Require evidence for overrides
- Escalate ambiguity rather than fabricate

Innovation portfolio

Select use cases by value, feasibility, controlability and learning speed.

- Prioritise low-risk high-frequency work
- Avoid consumer-impact decisions as first pilots
- Measure baseline before automation
- Design an exit path and fallback

Responsible experimentation

A sandbox is a control boundary, not a licence to upload sensitive data.

- Use synthetic or masked data
- Restrict connectors
- Log prompt and output tests
- Promote through governed environments

Finance use-case catalogue

Use case	Operating pattern	Value	Risk / control
Accounts payable invoice triage	Route invoices, detect missing fields and draft exception notes	Lower handling time	Invoice fraud and duplicate payments / Three-way match, duplicate rules, reviewer approval
Cash application	Match remittances to open invoices and explain residuals	Faster posting	Incorrect customer allocation / Tolerance rules, customer key validation, audit trail
Collections prioritisation	Rank overdue accounts and draft context-aware outreach	Improved DSO	Unfair or inappropriate communication / Approved templates and human send approval
Expense policy assistant	Answer employee expense questions from approved policy	Fewer queries	Outdated or unauthorised advice / Effective-date citations and escalation
Regulatory filing summarisation	Extract obligations and draft a review checklist	Faster interpretation	Hallucinated requirement / Primary-source citations and legal review
Earnings-call preparation	Synthesize performance drivers and likely stakeholder questions	Better preparation	Selective or misleading narrative / Reconcile to approved results and disclosures
Treasury liquidity briefing	Summarise cash, facilities and forecast risks	Faster visibility	Stale balances / As-of timestamps and source reconciliation
Credit memo drafting	Assemble borrower facts and analyst rationale	Analyst productivity	Bias and unsupported conclusions / Reason codes, source citations, credit approval
Insurance claims summarisation	Summarise documents and flag inconsistencies	Faster triage	Sensitive-data leakage and wrongful denial / Access control, human adjudication, appeal
Financial research synthesis	Summarise filings, transcripts and macro evidence	Broader coverage	Unverified market claims / Citations, as-of dates, restricted

			recommendation scope

Real-world cases

JPMorgan contract intelligence

Machine learning and language processing applied to high-volume contract review; use as a pattern for evidence extraction, not autonomous legal approval.

Source: Document review

OCBC AI portfolio

The legacy deck profiles customer, operations and decision-support uses; the updated lesson separates reported capability from training assumptions.

Source: Banking

Morgan Stanley knowledge assistant

A grounded assistant helps advisers navigate approved internal research while the adviser remains accountable for client advice.

Source: Wealth management

Control reflection

- Which source is authoritative and current?
- Which number, formula or action needs independent review?
- What evidence proves the control ran?
- When must the user refuse, escalate or fall back?

Topic 2: Excel Copilot for Finance Planning and Analysis

Data readiness, formulas, dashboards, FP&A, variance analysis, reconciliation and controls
Competency focus: K1 · A2

Core concepts

Copilot in Excel today

Copilot edits native Excel objects so the result remains reviewable and editable.

- Works with tables, formulas and cell ranges
- Creates charts and PivotTables
- Supports edit, plan and chat modes
- Can complete multi-step workbook tasks

Finance Agent surfaces

Finance Agent brings purpose-built processes into Excel, Outlook and Microsoft Copilot.

- Excel: reconciliation and variance analysis
- Outlook: collections context and communication
- Copilot: central finance insights
- ERP and FP&A connectivity varies by configuration

Workbook readiness

Reliable AI analysis starts with a flat, typed, labelled table.

- One row per business event
- Stable headers without merged cells
- Dates and currencies stored as real values
- Unique keys and clear dimensions

Table design for finance

Structure determines whether formulas and AI explanations reconcile.

- Separate source, assumptions and outputs
- Use Excel Tables and structured references
- Protect key formulas
- Document units and sign conventions

Plan, edit or chat

Choose the least invasive Copilot mode that meets the task.

- Chat for read-only exploration
- Plan to review an intended approach
- Edit for bounded workbook changes
- Review changes before acceptance

Formula generation

Generated formulas are proposals that require audit like human-authored formulas.

- Prefer transparent native functions
- Check ranges and absolute references

- Test edge cases and blanks
- Reconcile totals to a control figure

Finance formula toolkit

A compact formula vocabulary covers much of operational analysis.

- SUMIFS for controlled aggregation
- XLOOKUP for mapped dimensions
- IFERROR for explicit exception handling
- FORECAST.LINEAR and scenario assumptions for planning

Dashboard design

A finance dashboard is a decision surface, not a collage of charts.

- Show actual, budget and variance
- Use consistent time and currency units
- Expose exceptions and drivers
- Link every visual to traceable source data

Variance analysis

Variance analysis connects a number to its business drivers and next action.

- Define materiality criteria
- Compare compatible periods
- Identify top contributors
- Generate a narrative that cites the numbers

Period-over-period structure

Time columns and grouping determine the meaning of MoM, QoQ and YoY comparisons.

- Order periods consistently
- Separate source data from PivotTable
- Retain the comparison basis
- Check seasonality before escalation

Reconciliation design

Matching is a rules-and-evidence problem before it becomes an AI problem.

- Standardise keys and amounts
- Define exact and tolerance matches
- Separate timing from true exceptions
- Record disposition and reviewer

Close controls

Automation should strengthen evidence for completeness, accuracy and cut-off.

- Control totals before and after
- Exception queues with ageing
- Reviewer sign-off
- Immutable activity history

Forecasting with Copilot

Copilot accelerates model assembly, but assumptions remain management-owned.

- Start from operational drivers
- Separate base, upside and downside
- Use formulas instead of hard-coded outputs
- Back-test against actuals

Scenario planning

A scenario changes coherent assumptions, not isolated cells.

- Revenue volume and price
- Cost inflation and productivity
- Working-capital days
- Funding and liquidity constraints

Management commentary

A useful narrative quantifies the issue, identifies a driver and names an action.

- State magnitude and period
- Distinguish fact from hypothesis
- Name owner and due date
- Avoid unsupported causal claims

Excel control checklist

Before sharing an AI-assisted workbook, prove structure, formulas, outputs and access.

- Formula error scan
- Control-total reconciliation
- Sensitivity and edge-case tests
- Protected source and assumption ranges

Finance use-case catalogue

Use case	Operating pattern	Value	Risk / control
Budget build assistant	Create an editable driver-based budget structure	Faster model assembly	Hidden hard-codes / Formula audit and assumption register
Management variance analysis	Identify material period variances and draft drivers	Shorter reporting cycle	False causality / Materiality rules and evidence-backed narrative
Balance-sheet reconciliation	Compare account structures and generate reconciliation reports	Faster close	Incorrect matching / Deterministic rules, tolerance and reviewer sign-off
Intercompany matching	Match reciprocal entries and surface entity or FX differences	Fewer unresolved items	Cross-entity access leakage / Entity scoping and elimination controls
Revenue bridge	Decompose growth	Clearer performance	Incorrect attribution /

	into volume, price, mix and FX	story	Reconciled bridge and driver definitions
Rolling forecast	Extend forecast from recent actuals and operational drivers	Faster reforecast	Overfitting and stale assumptions / Back-testing and scenario review
Headcount cost forecast	Model hires, attrition, salary, bonus and vacancy timing	Better workforce planning	Personal-data exposure / Aggregate data and restricted payroll access
Working-capital dashboard	Visualise DSO, DPO, inventory days and cash conversion	Actionable cash view	Metric inconsistency / Definitions and control totals
Spend anomaly review	Highlight unusual vendor, amount or timing patterns	Leakage reduction	False accusations / Risk scores as triage only
Board pack production	Assemble charts, narrative and actions from approved workbook	Shorter reporting cycle	Disclosure inconsistency / Single approved source and CFO review

Real-world cases

Finance Agent reconciliation

Microsoft describes automated reconciliation reports, discrepancy suggestions and saved audit-ready summaries in Excel.

Source: Controllership

Finance Agent variance analysis

AI identifies material period variances, contributing factors and a structured narrative from flat source data and PivotTables.

Source: FP&A

Control reflection

- Which source is authoritative and current?
- Which number, formula or action needs independent review?
- What evidence proves the control ran?
- When must the user refuse, escalate or fall back?

Topic 3: Practical Applications of Agentic AI to Automate Financial Processes

Finance query agents, close orchestration, collections, reporting, multi-agent design and UAT
Competency focus: A3

Core concepts

Microsoft 365 Copilot in finance

The same grounded context can support analysis, communication and decision packs.

- Excel develops evidence
- Word structures the memo
- PowerPoint communicates the decision
- Outlook and Teams coordinate action

Finance query management

A Copilot Studio agent can answer policy and process questions from approved knowledge.

- Ground on finance policies
- Respect source permissions
- Return citations and effective dates
- Escalate exceptions to a human

Collections agent pattern

Collections combines ERP context, prioritisation and controlled communication.

- Prioritise by value and ageing
- Summarise account history
- Draft a context-aware message
- Require human approval before sending

Balance-sheet reconciliation agent

An agent can coordinate matching, evidence requests and reviewer handoffs.

- Ingest approved extracts
- Apply deterministic match rules
- Explain residual exceptions
- Prepare an auditable task queue

Copilot Studio building blocks

Knowledge, tools, topics and instructions must be designed as one control system.

- Knowledge answers
- Tools act
- Topics handle deterministic paths
- Instructions set operating boundaries

Agent authentication

An agent must know who is asking before retrieving or acting on finance data.

- Authenticate with Microsoft Entra ID
- Apply least privilege
- Preserve source-level permissions
- Avoid anonymous access for internal finance knowledge

Tools and connectors

Every connector expands both capability and data-exfiltration risk.

- Classify as business, non-business or blocked
- Separate read from write tools
- Constrain endpoints and actions
- Monitor connection ownership

Generative orchestration

The agent selects knowledge and tools dynamically; testing must cover unexpected routes.

- Test intent ambiguity
- Test tool-selection conflicts
- Test unavailable dependencies
- Test refusal and escalation

Multi-agent close

Specialist agents can prepare reconciliations, variances and commentary under a close supervisor.

- Reconciliation specialist
- Variance analyst
- Disclosure drafter
- Controller approval gate

Agent handoff contract

A handoff needs a structured payload, status and evidence pointer.

- Task and scope
- Input and source IDs
- Result and confidence
- Exceptions and required approval

UAT for finance agents

UAT proves usefulness and control performance under realistic data and edge cases.

- Happy path
- Missing and conflicting data
- Unauthorised user
- High-impact action requiring approval

Agent evaluation

Measure answer quality, groundedness, task completion and control adherence separately.

- Correctness
- Citation quality
- Tool success rate
- Policy violation rate

ALM and environments

Move agents through development, test and production with explicit approvals.

- Managed solutions
- Environment variables
- Connection references
- Release and rollback records

Operational monitoring

A live agent needs owners, telemetry and incident procedures.

- Usage and latency
- Failure and escalation rate
- Data-policy alerts
- Cost and capacity

When not to automate

Keep tasks human-led when judgement, novelty or irreversible impact dominates.

- Material journal approval
- Customer eligibility decisions
- Regulatory interpretation
- Unbounded external communication

Finance use-case catalogue

Use case	Operating pattern	Value	Risk / control
Internal finance query agent	Answer process and policy questions with citations	Reduced support load	Oversharing / Authentication, source permissions and DLP
Close orchestration agent	Coordinate tasks, owners, evidence and exceptions	More predictable close	Unapproved journal or sign-off / Read-only by default and explicit approvals
Collections copilot	Bring ERP context into Outlook and prepare response options	Scalable outreach	Automated external message risk / Human approval and communication log
Procure-to-pay exception agent	Gather missing evidence and route exceptions	Reduced queue ageing	Tool abuse / Whitelisted actions and amount thresholds
Tax research agent	Retrieve internal positions and authoritative guidance	Faster research	Outdated or cross-jurisdiction advice / Jurisdiction filters, effective dates, expert review
Audit evidence assistant	Index, retrieve and summarise evidence	Reduced search time	Evidence incompleteness /

	for test procedures		Evidence IDs and auditor judgement
Disclosure checklist agent	Map approved disclosures to evidence and owners	Fewer omissions	Wrong reporting basis / Controlled checklist and preparer/reviewer
Investment research multi-agent	Separate retrieval, financial analysis, risk challenge and writing	Traceable analysis	Compounding agent errors / Handoff schemas and independent challenge
Customer service banking agent	Answer product and service questions using approved content	24/7 support	Unsuitable advice / Scope limits and human handoff
Loan document review	Extract covenants, conditions and exceptions	Faster review	Missed clauses / Clause-level citations and legal review

Real-world cases

Finance query management

Microsoft's scenario library uses Copilot Studio to answer internal finance process questions from custom integrations and approved data.

Source: Finance operations

Collections agent

An agent combines customer and ERP context with drafted communication while retaining human accountability for external contact.

Source: Working capital

Balance-sheet reconciliation agent

An agent pattern accelerates matching, exception analysis and close evidence without removing reviewer sign-off.

Source: Close

Control reflection

- Which source is authoritative and current?
- Which number, formula or action needs independent review?
- What evidence proves the control ran?
- When must the user refuse, escalate or fall back?

Topic 4: AI Risk Management, Security and Fraud Detection

FEAT, model risk, cyber threats, identity, DLP, fraud analytics, monitoring and human oversight
Competency focus: K3 · A4

Core concepts

Finance AI risk taxonomy

AI risk spans data, model, cyber, compliance, third-party and human use.

- Data quality and leakage
- Bias, hallucination and drift
- Prompt injection and tool abuse
- Accountability and consumer harm

FEAT principles

Fairness, Ethics, Accountability and Transparency form a practical finance governance lens.

- Fair treatment and representative testing
- Ethical purpose and proportionality
- Named owners and challenge
- Understandable evidence and disclosure

Financial Services AI RMF

Govern, map, measure and manage must be adapted to operational and consumer impact.

- Govern accountability
- Map use and context
- Measure performance and harm
- Manage controls and residual risk

AI system inventory

You cannot govern finance AI that has no owner, data map or deployment record.

- Business purpose and tier
- Model and provider
- Data and connectors
- Owner, reviewer and renewal date

Risk tiering

Control intensity should rise with autonomy, data sensitivity and decision impact.

- Low: drafting and summarisation
- Moderate: analysis and recommendations
- High: material or customer-impact decisions
- Prohibited: uncontrolled sensitive-data actions

Prompt injection

Untrusted content can manipulate an agent into ignoring instructions or exfiltrating data.

- Treat retrieved content as data, not authority
- Filter and segment sources
- Constrain tools independently
- Test adversarial instructions

Data poisoning

Corrupted training or grounding data can create persistent and plausible errors.

- Track data lineage
- Validate source integrity
- Separate maker from approver
- Monitor unexpected distribution shifts

Sensitive-data leakage

Finance prompts can expose payroll, customer, transaction or strategy data.

- Classify and minimise
- Use DLP and sensitivity labels
- Restrict public knowledge sources
- Log and investigate risky use

Identity and access

Agent permissions should never exceed the speaking user's authorised finance access.

- Entra authentication
- Conditional Access
- Role-based permissions
- Periodic access reviews

Third-party risk

AI providers concentrate operational, data, model and exit risk.

- Due diligence and contract terms
- Data-use and retention controls
- Resilience and incident notification
- Portability and exit plan

Model risk

Performance evidence must match the intended finance decision and operating conditions.

- Independent validation
- Benchmark and challenger
- Limitations and use restrictions
- Monitoring and revalidation

Hallucination controls

Fluent text is not evidence; high-impact claims need retrieval and reconciliation.

- Require citations
- Constrain to known sources
- Verify numbers independently
- Escalate missing evidence

Fraud detection pipeline

Fraud AI combines behavioural features, probabilistic scores and investigator feedback.

- Ingest and clean
- Engineer temporal and entity features
- Score and prioritise
- Investigate, label and retrain

Class imbalance

High accuracy can hide a model that misses nearly every fraud case.

- Use precision and recall
- Inspect PR-AUC
- Tune threshold to business cost
- Stratify evaluation data

Confusion-matrix economics

False positives create friction; false negatives create loss and harm.

- Quantify review cost
- Quantify expected fraud loss
- Choose threshold with capacity
- Review segment-level impact

Explainability

Finance needs reasons suitable for reviewers, customers and regulators.

- Global feature importance
- Local reason codes
- Counterfactual or sensitivity analysis
- Plain-language limitation statement

Fraud alert narrative

Generation adds value after detection by assembling evidence into a controlled case summary.

- What happened
- Why it is unusual
- Evidence and model score
- Recommended next action and approver

Monitoring and drift

Fraud tactics, populations and economic conditions change.

- Track precision and recall
- Monitor feature distributions
- Capture investigator outcomes
- Retrain through approved change control

Copilot Studio DLP

Data policies separate business, non-business and blocked connectors.

- Prevent risky connector combinations
- Block unauthenticated channels

- Restrict knowledge sources
- Enforce policies in real time

Security-by-design gate

An agent should not publish until identity, data, tools, testing and monitoring are approved.

- Threat model
- DLP and access
- UAT and adversarial tests
- Owner, runbook and rollback

Finance use-case catalogue

Use case	Operating pattern	Value	Risk / control
Card fraud detection	Score transactions using behaviour, merchant and device signals	Lower fraud loss	False positives and model drift / Threshold economics and investigator feedback
AML investigation summarisation	Assemble transactions, entities and evidence into a case narrative	Faster investigation	Privacy and confirmation bias / Evidence links and investigator approval
Account takeover detection	Detect device, location and behavioural anomalies	Faster containment	Customer friction / Step-up verification and risk thresholds
Synthetic fraud scenario generation	Generate rare attack patterns for resilience testing	Broader test coverage	Unrealistic or unsafe scenarios / Domain review and isolated test data
Model documentation copilot	Draft model cards, limitations and monitoring summaries	Consistent documentation	False completeness / Required fields and independent validation
Policy compliance monitor	Compare agent configuration with approved control requirements	Earlier control detection	Blind spots in telemetry / Configuration inventory and periodic review
Prompt-injection test agent	Generate and execute adversarial test cases in a sandbox	Stronger resilience	Unsafe testing against production / Isolated environment and no live secrets
Vendor AI due diligence	Summarise contracts, controls, data use and concentration risk	Faster review	Reliance on vendor claims / Evidence request and accountable approval

Cyber alert enrichment	Summarise threat intelligence and affected financial assets	Faster response	Poisoned external content / Trusted feeds and tool isolation
Fair lending monitoring	Test model outcomes and explanations across groups	Reduced bias risk	Sensitive attribute misuse / Governed fairness testing and remediation

Real-world cases

Mastercard fraud intelligence

A reported GenAI-enhanced fraud model analyses transaction and device context to support suspicious-transaction assessment.

Source: Payments

Standard Chartered security balance

A real-world discussion of innovation with security reinforces layered controls, identity, monitoring and operational resilience.

Source: Banking security

US Treasury sector findings

Treasury highlights data poisoning, leakage, integrity, explainability, third-party concentration and cross-enterprise governance.

Source: Financial services

Control reflection

- Which source is authoritative and current?
- Which number, formula or action needs independent review?
- What evidence proves the control ran?
- When must the user refuse, escalate or fall back?

Topic 5: Future Trends and Innovations in Generative AI for Finance

Finance-agent roadmaps, cost controls, operating models, change leadership and measurable value
Competency focus: K4 · A5

Core concepts

Finance-agent direction

Finance AI is moving from isolated assistance to process-specific, governed agents.

- Variance analysis actions
- Reconciliation workflows
- Collections assistance
- ERP-grounded finance insights

Assistive to autonomous

Autonomy should expand only after templates, thresholds and monitoring are proven.

- Assist in the moment
- Save a repeatable template
- Run as a bounded AI action
- Retain review and exception gates

Operating-model shift

Finance teams need product ownership for AI-enabled processes.

- Business product owner
- Finance control owner
- Technology platform owner
- Risk and compliance challenge

AI portfolio economics

Total cost includes licences, integration, data, review, controls and change.

- Baseline current effort
- Model run and capacity costs
- Build and control costs
- Benefits realised after adoption

Cost controls

Control cost by standardising platforms and reusing governed patterns.

- Shared connectors and knowledge
- Reusable evaluation sets
- Tiered model choice
- Usage budgets and showback

Business case

A defensible case links use, adoption, control and financial outcome.

- Volume and unit effort
- Adoption curve
- Control cost
- Cash, capacity or risk benefit

Lewin for finance AI

Unfreeze, change and refreeze turns a pilot into a controlled operating habit.

- Unfreeze with evidence and urgency
- Change through pilots and training
- Refreeze policies and metrics
- Continue learning as technology changes

Pilot selection

Choose a process with clear data, measurable pain and reversible actions.

- High volume
- Known baseline
- Available owner
- Low-to-moderate impact

Scaling gate

A successful demo is not production readiness.

- Security and compliance
- Reliability and capacity
- Support and incident response
- Benefits and user adoption

Vendor roadmap discipline

Roadmap features are planning inputs, not current capabilities.

- Verify release status
- Test in your tenant
- Document licensing and region
- Avoid designing controls around previews

Workforce readiness

Finance professionals need AI literacy plus stronger judgement and control skills.

- Prompt and data literacy
- Review and challenge
- Process redesign
- Ethics and accountability

Future-proof architecture

Keep data, controls and process logic portable as models change.

- Modular tools
- Documented interfaces
- Provider-independent evaluation
- Exit and rollback path

Measure realised value

Track outcomes after launch, not only activity or token usage.

- Cycle time
- Quality and exception rate
- Cash and risk outcomes
- Adoption and satisfaction

Continuous governance

Reassess AI use when data, models, regulations or business context change.

- Periodic risk review
- Revalidation triggers
- Policy and inventory updates
- Retirement of unused agents

Finance use-case catalogue

Use case	Operating pattern	Value	Risk / control
Finance AI use-case portfolio	Score initiatives on value, feasibility, risk and reuse	Better investment choices	Optimism bias / Stage gates and realised-benefit review
Licence and capacity optimisation	Track agent usage and right-size licences or message capacity	Lower run cost	Under-provisioning critical workflows / Service tiers and usage budgets
Agent factory	Reuse identity, knowledge, tool, evaluation and monitoring patterns	Faster safe delivery	Agent sprawl / Catalogue, templates and retirement
AI-enabled finance operating model	Define product, control, data and platform ownership	Sustainable scale	Ambiguous accountability / RACI and lifecycle governance
Legacy process modernisation	Use agents to bridge old workflows while redesigning the target process	Faster transition	Permanent fragile workarounds / Sunset plan and architecture review
Continuous controls monitoring	Monitor control evidence and exceptions across the period	Earlier detection	Alert fatigue / Materiality and owner workflows
Digital finance coach	Deliver role-based guidance using approved internal learning	Faster adoption	Incorrect guidance / Curated knowledge and feedback

AI investment committee pack	Combine value, risk, cost and readiness evidence for gate decisions	Disciplined scaling	Metric gaming / Independent challenge and post-investment review

Real-world cases

Financial Services AI RMF

The 2026 framework adapts NIST AI RMF to financial-services operational, regulatory and consumer-protection considerations.

Source: [Governance]

Control reflection

- Which source is authoritative and current?
- Which number, formula or action needs independent review?
- What evidence proves the control ran?
- When must the user refuse, escalate or fall back?

Detailed lab procedures

Connected Northstar Finance scenario
All ten labs use one synthetic organisation. Learners progress from use-case selection to Excel analysis, agent design, UAT, fraud/security and an economically governed roadmap.

Lab 1: Prioritise a Finance AI Use-Case Portfolio

Field	Requirement
Topic / criteria	1 / K2 · A1
Duration	90 minutes
Scenario	Northstar Finance is selecting its first governed AI pilots across FP&A, controllership, treasury, risk and customer operations.
Objective	Score finance AI opportunities by value, feasibility, risk and learning speed.
Output	A prioritised portfolio and one-page pilot charter.

Before you begin

- Open labs/01-*/README.pdf and the starter workbook.
- Work only with the supplied synthetic data; never paste live finance or customer data.
- Save a working copy with your name or assigned learner ID.
- Keep formulas, prompts, screenshots and review notes as evidence.

Step 1: Review the synthetic use-case backlog and confirm the scoring definitions.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 1, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 2: Use the weighted scoring sheet to rank initiatives.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.

- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 2, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 3: Challenge the top three for data, control and adoption constraints.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 3, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 4: Select one pilot and complete the charter with owner, scope, baseline, KPI and stop condition.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 4, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 5: Peer-review the decision and record unresolved evidence.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 5, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Acceptance criteria

Weights total 100%; every shortlisted use case has a named owner, baseline KPI, risk tier and stop condition.

Close-out

- Compare the starter and solution structures only after completing your own work.
- Submit the learner-created output specified by the trainer.
- Remove personal data, credentials and unapproved external links before submission.

Lab 2: Prepare Finance Data for Copilot in Excel

Field	Requirement
Topic / criteria	2 / K1 · A2
Duration	90 minutes
Scenario	The FP&A team receives a mixed-quality export from the billing system and must prepare it for Copilot analysis.
Objective	Convert messy finance transactions into an analysis-ready Excel Table with control totals.
Output	A clean transactions table, quality log and reconciled control totals.

Before you begin

- Open labs/02-*/README.pdf and the starter workbook.
- Work only with the supplied synthetic data; never paste live finance or customer data.
- Save a working copy with your name or assigned learner ID.
- Keep formulas, prompts, screenshots and review notes as evidence.

Step 1: Open the starter workbook and review the Data Dictionary and expected control total.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 1, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 2: Convert the source range to an Excel Table and standardise headers.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 2, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 3: Correct date, currency, account and department fields without changing transaction IDs.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 3, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 4: Use validation formulas to detect missing keys, duplicates and invalid signs.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 4, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 5: Reconcile clean revenue and expense totals to the control sheet.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 5, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 6: Ask Copilot in chat mode to identify trends and outliers, then verify each claim against the table.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.

- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 6, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Acceptance criteria

Duplicate count is zero, required-field errors are zero, and clean totals reconcile to the supplied control figures.

Close-out

- Compare the starter and solution structures only after completing your own work.
- Submit the learner-created output specified by the trainer.
- Remove personal data, credentials and unapproved external links before submission.

Lab 3: Build an FP&A Formula Model and Dashboard

Field	Requirement
Topic / criteria	2 / K1 · A2
Duration	150 minutes
Scenario	Northstar's CFO needs a monthly performance dashboard and a transparent base/downside forecast.
Objective	Use native finance formulas, scenarios and charts to build an auditable management dashboard.
Output	An editable dashboard with actual, budget, variance, forecast and driver views.

Before you begin

- Open labs/03-*/README.pdf and the starter workbook.
- Work only with the supplied synthetic data; never paste live finance or customer data.
- Save a working copy with your name or assigned learner ID.
- Keep formulas, prompts, screenshots and review notes as evidence.

Step 1: Review the source Actuals, Budget and Assumptions tables.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 1, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 2: Complete SUMIFS, XLOOKUP, IFERROR, growth and margin formulas in the Analysis sheet.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint

Record completion of step 2, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 3: Build base and downside forecasts from volume, price, cost and working-capital assumptions.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 3, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 4: Create KPI tiles and native charts linked to the Analysis table.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 4, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 5: Use Copilot plan mode to propose improvements; accept only changes that preserve auditability.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 5, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 6: Run the formula and control checks before exporting the executive summary.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.

- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 6, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Acceptance criteria

Dashboard charts remain linked to data; all formula checks pass; total variance equals actual less budget; scenarios use assumption cells rather than hard-coded outputs.

Close-out

- Compare the starter and solution structures only after completing your own work.
- Submit the learner-created output specified by the trainer.
- Remove personal data, credentials and unapproved external links before submission.

Lab 4: Reconcile Accounts and Explain Variances

Field	Requirement
Topic / criteria	2 / K1 · A2
Duration	120 minutes
Scenario	The controller must reconcile ERP and bank/ledger extracts and explain material monthly movements.
Objective	Apply deterministic matching and Finance Agent-style variance analysis to a month-end close.
Output	A reconciliation report, exception queue and evidence-backed variance narrative.

Before you begin

- Open labs/04-*/README.pdf and the starter workbook.
- Work only with the supplied synthetic data; never paste live finance or customer data.
- Save a working copy with your name or assigned learner ID.
- Keep formulas, prompts, screenshots and review notes as evidence.

Step 1: Review the two source tables and control totals.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 1, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 2: Apply exact, reference and tolerance match logic.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint

Record completion of step 2, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 3: Classify timing items separately from unresolved exceptions.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 3, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 4: Create the reconciliation summary and assign exception owners.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 4, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 5: Prepare a PivotTable-ready variance table with ordered periods.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 5, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 6: Use Finance Agent or Copilot to draft a narrative, then verify every number and remove unsupported causality.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.

- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 6, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Acceptance criteria

Matched plus exception values reconcile to each source; all unresolved items have a reason and owner; the narrative cites actual values and materiality thresholds.

Close-out

- Compare the starter and solution structures only after completing your own work.
- Submit the learner-created output specified by the trainer.
- Remove personal data, credentials and unapproved external links before submission.

Lab 5: Create a Microsoft 365 Finance Decision Pack

Field	Requirement
Topic / criteria	3 / A3
Duration	90 minutes
Scenario	The CFO needs a board-ready summary and a draft response to a major overdue customer.
Objective	Turn approved Excel evidence into a controlled Word brief, PowerPoint story and collections message.
Output	A three-part decision pack with traceable numbers and approval status.

Before you begin

- Open labs/05-*/README.pdf and the starter workbook.
- Work only with the supplied synthetic data; never paste live finance or customer data.
- Save a working copy with your name or assigned learner ID.
- Keep formulas, prompts, screenshots and review notes as evidence.

Step 1: Verify the approved KPI and collections tables in the workbook.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 1, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 2: Use Microsoft 365 Copilot to draft a Word decision brief with source labels.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 2, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 3: Create a concise PowerPoint narrative using only approved figures.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 3, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 4: Draft an Outlook collections message that reflects account history and policy.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 4, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 5: Mark the message as draft and route it for human approval.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 5, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 6: Cross-check every repeated number across Excel, Word and PowerPoint.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.

- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 6, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Acceptance criteria

All repeated figures match the source workbook; facts and recommendations are separated; the external message remains a draft with an approver.

Close-out

- Compare the starter and solution structures only after completing your own work.
- Submit the learner-created output specified by the trainer.
- Remove personal data, credentials and unapproved external links before submission.

Lab 6: Build a Grounded Finance Query Agent

Field	Requirement
Topic / criteria	3 / A3
Duration	150 minutes
Scenario	Finance staff need reliable answers about expenses, close deadlines, delegation and reconciliation evidence.
Objective	Build and test a Copilot Studio agent grounded on approved finance policies.
Output	A finance query agent, knowledge pack, test evidence and escalation design.

Before you begin

- Open labs/06-*/README.pdf and the starter workbook.
- Work only with the supplied synthetic data; never paste live finance or customer data.
- Save a working copy with your name or assigned learner ID.
- Keep formulas, prompts, screenshots and review notes as evidence.

Step 1: Review the supplied policy knowledge files and identify effective dates and owners.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 1, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 2: Create the agent in a governed development environment and require authentication.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 2, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 3: Write instructions that constrain answers to approved knowledge and require citations.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 3, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 4: Add a deterministic escalation topic for missing or conflicting policy.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 4, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 5: Run the positive, negative, stale-source and unauthorised-user tests in the UAT workbook.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 5, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 6: Record defects, retest fixes and capture publish-readiness evidence.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.

- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 6, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Acceptance criteria

The agent cites approved sources, refuses unsupported answers, respects access boundaries and passes all critical UAT cases before any publish decision.

Close-out

- Compare the starter and solution structures only after completing your own work.
- Submit the learner-created output specified by the trainer.
- Remove personal data, credentials and unapproved external links before submission.

Lab 7: Design and UAT a Multi-Agent Close Workflow

Field	Requirement
Topic / criteria	3 / A3
Duration	150 minutes
Scenario	Northstar wants reconciliation, variance and disclosure agents coordinated by a close supervisor without autonomous journal approval.
Objective	Design a supervisor and specialist-agent workflow with structured handoffs and approval gates.
Output	An agent architecture, handoff contract, RACI, UAT results and rollback plan.

Before you begin

- Open labs/07-*/README.pdf and the starter workbook.
- Work only with the supplied synthetic data; never paste live finance or customer data.
- Save a working copy with your name or assigned learner ID.
- Keep formulas, prompts, screenshots and review notes as evidence.

Step 1: Map the current close process and select bounded tasks for each specialist agent.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

> **Evidence checkpoint**
> Record completion of step 1, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 2: Define the supervisor's orchestration rules and human approval points.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

> **Evidence checkpoint**
> Record completion of step 2, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 3: Complete the handoff schema for task, source IDs, result, confidence and exceptions.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

> **Evidence checkpoint**
> Record completion of step 3, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 4: Configure or prototype the flow in Copilot Studio using read-only tools.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

> **Evidence checkpoint**
> Record completion of step 4, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 5: Execute happy-path, missing-data, tool-failure and approval-bypass tests.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

> **Evidence checkpoint**
> Record completion of step 5, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 6: Document monitoring, incident response and rollback ownership.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.

- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 6, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Acceptance criteria

No agent can approve or post a journal; every handoff is structured; critical tests pass; monitoring and rollback have named owners.

Close-out

- Compare the starter and solution structures only after completing your own work.
- Submit the learner-created output specified by the trainer.
- Remove personal data, credentials and unapproved external links before submission.

Lab 8: Evaluate a Fraud Model and Alert Narrative

Field	Requirement
Topic / criteria	4 / K3 · A4
Duration	150 minutes
Scenario	A card issuer must reduce fraud loss without overwhelming investigators or blocking legitimate customers.
Objective	Choose a fraud threshold using precision, recall, business cost and explainability.
Output	A threshold decision, confusion matrix, alert queue and controlled case narrative.

Before you begin

- Open labs/08-*/README.pdf and the starter workbook.
- Work only with the supplied synthetic data; never paste live finance or customer data.
- Save a working copy with your name or assigned learner ID.
- Keep formulas, prompts, screenshots and review notes as evidence.

Step 1: Review the synthetic scored transactions and feature definitions.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 1, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 2: Calculate confusion-matrix metrics at the supplied thresholds.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 2, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 3: Estimate false-positive review cost and false-negative fraud loss.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

> **Evidence checkpoint**
> Record completion of step 3, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 4: Select a threshold that fits investigator capacity and risk appetite.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

> **Evidence checkpoint**
> Record completion of step 4, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 5: Explain three alerts using evidence and limitations.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

> **Evidence checkpoint**
> Record completion of step 5, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 6: Use GenAI to draft one case narrative, then verify and approve it as investigator work product.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.

- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 6, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Acceptance criteria

The threshold decision cites precision, recall, cost and capacity; alert explanations use real fields; the generated narrative is labelled draft and evidence-linked.

Close-out

- Compare the starter and solution structures only after completing your own work.
- Submit the learner-created output specified by the trainer.
- Remove personal data, credentials and unapproved external links before submission.

Lab 9: Threat-Model and Secure a Finance Agent

Field	Requirement
Topic / criteria	4 / K3 · A4
Duration	120 minutes
Scenario	The finance query agent is proposed for wider deployment with SharePoint knowledge and workflow connectors.
Objective	Apply identity, DLP, prompt-injection, data, tool and monitoring controls to a finance agent.
Output	A threat model, control matrix, adversarial test log and publish recommendation.

Before you begin

- Open labs/09-*/README.pdf and the starter workbook.
- Work only with the supplied synthetic data; never paste live finance or customer data.
- Save a working copy with your name or assigned learner ID.
- Keep formulas, prompts, screenshots and review notes as evidence.

Step 1: Inventory users, data, knowledge sources, tools and external dependencies.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 1, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 2: Map prompt injection, leakage, poisoning, tool abuse, identity and third-party threats.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 2, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 3: Assign preventive, detective and responsive controls using the control matrix.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 3, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 4: Classify connectors into business, non-business and blocked groups.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 4, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 5: Run the supplied adversarial prompts using synthetic data only.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 5, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 6: Issue a publish, remediate or reject recommendation with residual risk and owner.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.

- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 6, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Acceptance criteria

Every high risk has a preventive and detective control, test evidence, residual rating and accountable owner; no live credentials or customer data are used.

Close-out

- Compare the starter and solution structures only after completing your own work.
- Submit the learner-created output specified by the trainer.
- Remove personal data, credentials and unapproved external links before submission.

Lab 10: Build the Finance AI Business Case and Roadmap

Field	Requirement
Topic / criteria	5 / K4 · A5
Duration	150 minutes
Scenario	The investment committee must decide whether to scale the Northstar finance AI portfolio after the pilots.
Objective	Create a stage-gated adoption roadmap with total-cost, benefit, risk and cash-flow controls.
Output	A 12-month roadmap, cash-flow model, NPV, stage gates and benefits-realisation scorecard.

Before you begin

- Open labs/10-*/README.pdf and the starter workbook.
- Work only with the supplied synthetic data; never paste live finance or customer data.
- Save a working copy with your name or assigned learner ID.
- Keep formulas, prompts, screenshots and review notes as evidence.

Step 1: Baseline volumes, effort, quality and cash outcomes from the supplied data.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 1, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 2: Estimate licence, integration, data, control, change and run costs.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 2, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 3: Model adoption, benefit ramp, downside and termination scenarios.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 3, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 4: Calculate monthly net cash flow, cumulative cash and NPV.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 4, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 5: Define stage gates for security, reliability, adoption and realised value.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.
- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 5, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Step 6: Prepare an investment recommendation and a 12-month roadmap with owners.

- Read the relevant worksheet, scenario note and acceptance criterion before making a change.
- Perform the bounded task in Excel, Microsoft 365 Copilot or Copilot Studio as directed by the trainer.
- Use a prompt contract that states role, task, approved sources, control constraints and required output structure when generative AI is used.

- Reconcile the result to a control total, cited source, deterministic rule or expected result. Investigate exceptions; do not overwrite them silently.
- Capture the resulting workbook cell, formula, chart, agent response, test result or approval decision in the evidence checklist.

Evidence checkpoint
Record completion of step 6, the evidence location, reviewer status and any unresolved exception.

Acceptance criteria

Costs include build, run, control and change; benefits are adoption-adjusted; NPV links to cash-flow cells; each stage gate has evidence, owner and stop condition.

Close-out

- Compare the starter and solution structures only after completing your own work.
- Submit the learner-created output specified by the trainer.
- Remove personal data, credentials and unapproved external links before submission.

Finance AI security checklist

Control area	Questions to answer
Identity and access	Is the user authenticated? Are source permissions preserved? Is least privilege applied?
Data protection	Is financial data classified? Are DLP policies and approved connectors enforced?
Model and prompt risk	Are grounding, refusal, prompt-injection and hallucination tests documented?
Action safety	Are write tools, monetary thresholds and approvals bounded?
Monitoring	Are logs, owners, incidents, cost and drift reviewed?
Accountability	Can the reviewer reproduce the evidence and explain the final decision?

References

Course page

Copilot in Excel - Get started

Finance Agent overview

Variance analysis in Excel

Microsoft finance scenario library

Copilot Studio security and governance

Copilot Studio data policies

Copilot Studio secure projects

Microsoft Copilot Control System

MAS FEAT principles

US Treasury AI in Financial Services

US Treasury AI cybersecurity risks

Financial Services AI Risk Management Framework announcement

Databricks finance AI outlook

Databricks AI applications in finance

Association for Financial Professionals - AI in finance